Smarkets API Support — Agent Knowledge Base

Smarkets API Support Team

June 2026

Smarkets API Support — Agent Knowledge Base

Status: ■ Live | **Owner:** API Support Team | **Last reviewed:** June 2026 | **Labels:** `api-support` `triage` `training` `external-facing`

> ***How to use this page:*** *A customer reports an issue. Ctrl+F what they're saying (e.g. "401", "token expired", "order rejected", "rate limit") to jump to the relevant section. If nothing matches, escalate to tech support.*

Table of Contents

Exchange & API Basics (read these first)

- What is Smarkets? (Exchange Basics for CS Agents)
- How the API Works (for Non-Tech Agents)
- Order Types Explained Simply
- Commission Tiers
- Price & Quantity Format (Plain English)

Error Code Reference (the main lookup sections)

- Quick-Find Index
- How API Calls Work
- 401 — Login / Token Issues
- 403 — Permission Problems
- Login Errors (All Codes)
- 400 — Bad Request / Wrong Data
- 404 — Not Found / Missing Data
- 414 — Request Too Large
- 429 — Too Many Requests
- 451 — Country Blocked
- 500, 503 & 504 — Smarkets Server Issues
- Order Rejection Codes (POST /v3/orders/)
- Cancel-Order Rejection Codes (DELETE /v3/orders/{id}/)

Reference & Troubleshooting

- Common Customer Scenarios
- Quick Reference Table
- Frequently Asked Questions
- API Terms & Policy Quick Reference
- Account Verification (KYC)
- Deposits & Withdrawals
- Responsible Gambling
- When to Flag for Technical Support
- Useful Links & Resources

What is Smarkets? (Exchange Basics for CS Agents)

Why this section exists
You don't need to be a betting expert to help with API queries. But customers will use betting terms, and you need to understand what they mean to identify the right section. This section covers the basics in plain English.

What is a betting exchange?

A betting exchange is a platform where customers bet against each other, not against a bookmaker. Think of it like a stock market for sports — instead of buying shares, customers are backing and laying outcomes.

Smarkets is a betting exchange. The key difference from a traditional bookmaker:

- **Bookmaker (like SBK, Bet365, William Hill):** Sets the odds themselves. You bet against the house. The bookmaker decides whether to accept your bet.
- **Betting exchange (like Smarkets):** Customers set the odds. You bet against other customers. The exchange just matches you up. Smarkets takes a small commission on winnings.

Back vs Lay (simple explanation)

- **Back bet:** Betting that something WILL happen. "I think Arsenal will win."
- **Lay bet:** Betting that something WON'T happen. "I think Arsenal won't win." This is like playing the bookmaker — you're offering odds to someone else.

When a customer places a lay bet, they need to have enough money to pay out if the bet loses. This is called their **liability**.

What is SBK vs Smarkets?

- **Smarkets** is the betting exchange — customers bet against each other.
- **SBK** is Smarkets' sportsbook — a traditional bookmaker product where Smarkets sets the odds.
- The API is for the **exchange** (Smarkets), not SBK.
- A customer can have both a Smarkets exchange account and an SBK account, but they are separate products with separate balances.

What is commission?

On a betting exchange, commission is how the platform makes money. Smarkets charges commission on net profit per market — not on every bet.

- If you win money on a market, you pay commission on your profit.
- If you lose money on a market, you pay no commission.
- The default rate is **2%** (Standard Tier).

Commission is calculated per market, not per bet. If you place multiple bets on the same market and some win while others lose, the commission is on your net result for that market.

For full commission tier details, see the Commission Tiers section below.

What is exposure?

When a customer has open (unmatched) orders, the potential liability of those orders is "locked up" — they can't spend that money on other bets. This is called **exposure**.

If a customer says "I have money in my account but can't place a bet," the most common reason is that their available balance is tied up in exposure from existing open orders. Cancel the open orders to free up the balance.

How the API Works (for Non-Tech Agents)

Why this section exists
API customers will use technical terms in their queries. You need to understand the basics to identify which error they're hitting — but you don't need to understand the code itself.

What is an API?

An API (Application Programming Interface) is a way for a customer's software to talk to Smarkets directly, without using the website. Instead of clicking buttons on smarkets.com, their program sends text requests to a web address, and Smarkets sends back text responses.

What is a session token?

Think of a session token like a cinema ticket:

1. You "buy" the ticket by logging in (sending your username and password).
2. You show the ticket at the door for every request (every API call includes the token).
3. The ticket expires after 30 minutes if you don't use it.
4. Every time you do use it, it gets renewed for another 30 minutes.
5. If the ticket expires, you need to buy a new one (log in again).

The token goes in a header called `Authorization` with the format:

```
Authorization: Session-Token <their_token>
```

What is MFA?

MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication, also called 2FA or TOTP) is an extra security step. If the customer has MFA enabled, logging in returns a **limited** session token. They must then send a 6-digit code from their authenticator app via a second step (`POST /v3/sessions/verify/`) to get a fully authorised token.

If a customer gets a 401 when trying to place bets but login seemed to work, MFA verification is often the missing step.

The event hierarchy (how markets are organised)

Smarkets organises events in a hierarchy:

1. **Event** — the thing happening (e.g. "Arsenal vs Chelsea")
2. **Market** — what you can bet on within that event (e.g. "Match Winner", "Over/Under 2.5 Goals")
3. **Contract** — the specific outcome within a market (e.g. "Arsenal to Win", "Draw", "Chelsea to Win")
4. **Order** — the actual bet placed on a contract

Customers need the correct IDs for each level to place bets. If they get a 404, they likely have a wrong ID somewhere in this chain.

Paper trading vs live trading

Smarkets has two environments:

- **Paper trading** — a test environment with fake money for development and testing.
- **Live trading** — the real environment with real money.

Tokens from one environment do NOT work in the other. If a customer switches from paper to live (or vice versa), they need a fresh token from the new environment.

Which endpoints need authentication?

Endpoint group	Needs token?
Events, competitors, contracts, currencies	No — public
Quotes, prices	Yes — and prices are delayed without one
Orders, account info, account activity	Yes
Sessions (login, logout, MFA)	No — these are how you GET a token

Order Types Explained Simply

> **When customers ask about order types**
> Customers may mention "Fill-or-Kill", "FOK", "IOC", "time_in_force", or "immediate_or_cancel". These are all about how their order behaves when placed.

The Smarkets API does NOT have a `time_in_force` field. If a customer mentions it, it's from their own code or another exchange (like Binance). Smarkets uses the `type` field instead.

Order type	What it does	When to use it
`good_til_cancelled`	Stays open until the customer cancels it, or the market goes live/settles	Default — most bets
`keep_in_play`	Same as above but survives market state changes during in-play	For in-play betting
`good_til_halted`	Cancelled automatically when the market is halted	For pre-event bets that shouldn't survive into in-play
`immediate_or_cancel`	Only matches what's available right now. Any unmatched portion is cancelled.	For "fill what you can, cancel the rest"

Fill-or-Kill (FOK): This isn't a separate order type on Smarkets. To get FOK behaviour, use `type: "immediate_or_cancel"` AND set `minimum_accepted_quantity` to the same value as `quantity`. This means: "fill the entire amount or cancel the whole thing."

Immediate-or-Cancel (IOC): Same `type: "immediate_or_cancel"` but with `minimum_accepted_quantity` set lower than `quantity`. This means: "fill at least this much, cancel whatever's left."

Common gotcha: If the customer omits `minimum_accepted_quantity` on an `immediate_or_cancel` order entirely, the system may accept a zero-match and cancel immediately with nothing filled. Always set it explicitly.

Commission Tiers

When customers ask about commission
"I'm paying 2% — can I get a lower rate?" / "I thought API users get 1%?" / "What is the Pro Tier?" / "commission_type shows 0.02"

Smarkets has three commission tiers. API access does NOT automatically give you a lower rate — the same tiers apply whether you trade via the website, mobile app, or API.

Tier	Rate	How it works	How to get it
Standard	2%	Default for all accounts. Charged on net profit per market.	Automatic — all accounts start here
Pro	1%	For high-volume traders. Charged on profit AND loss per matched bet.	Must opt in via support after hitting 80% of a threshold (1,500 bets/month OR £1M staked/month)
Select	3%	For the most profitable accounts. Applied automatically.	Auto-applied when net profit exceeds £25,000 over previous 12 calendar months

Key facts to tell customers:

- API access does NOT give you a lower commission rate. The same tiers apply to everyone.
- API users are NOT eligible for the 60-day 0% new customer offer or affiliate commission offers (per Section 3 of API T&Cs).
- API users CAN get the Pro Tier (1%) — it's a volume-based tier, not a promotion. They just need to meet the thresholds and opt in.
- Opting into Pro Tier permanently forfeits any commission promotion.
- You can opt back out of Pro Tier after 3 months.
- The Select Tier is applied automatically — customers are notified by email 7 days before it takes effect.
- Commission is charged per individual matched bet that settles, not just on winning bets (for Pro and Select tiers).

Full commission details at help.smarkets.com.

Price & Quantity Format (Plain English)

When customers ask about price/quantity
"It says ORDER_INVALID_INVALID_PRICE" / "My stake is wrong" / "What does 5000 mean?" / "I tried to bet £2 but it shows £0.08"

The API uses internal number formats that are different from what customers see on the website. This is a common source of confusion.

Price format

Prices on the API are in **percentage basis points** (out of 10,000).

API price	Percentage	Decimal odds	What it means
5000	50%	2.0	Even money
2500	25%	4.0	3/1 against
1000	10%	10.0	9/1 against
9000	90%	1.11	Very short favourite

To convert API price to decimal odds: Divide 10,000 by the price.

- Example: 10,000 ÷ 5000 = 2.0 (decimal odds)
- Example: 10,000 ÷ 2500 = 4.0 (decimal odds)

Valid prices must be on the exchange tick structure — not every number is valid.

Quantity format

Quantities are in **1/10,000th of one unit of the customer's currency**.

API quantity	GBP equivalent
500	£0.05 (minimum stake)
10,000	£1.00
20,000	£2.00
100,000	£10.00

Common confusion: A customer says "I bet £2.00" but they see a stake of £0.08 on the website. This means they sent `quantity: 800` in their API request — which is £0.08, not £2.00. They need to send `quantity: 20000` for £2.00.

Quick-Find Index

How to use this index
If a customer says any of these exact phrases, Ctrl+F the phrase here to find the right section.

If the customer says...	Jump to section
"I'm getting a 401" / "My token isn't working" / "It says AUTH_REQUIRED"	401 — Login / token issues
"I keep getting logged out" / "My session expired"	401 — Login / token issues
"I'm getting a 403" / "It says FORBIDDEN"	403 — Permission problems
"I was working fine and now I'm blocked"	403 — Permission problems
"I can't login at all" / "My password isn't working" / "INVALID_CREDENTIALS"	Login errors (all codes)
"It says COUNTRY_BLOCKED" / "I'm in the wrong country?"	451 — Country blocked
"I can't place bets" / "My order was rejected" / "ORDER_REJECTED"	Order rejection codes (POST /v3/orders/)
"I can't cancel my order" / "ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED"	Cancel-order rejection codes (DELETE /v3/orders/{id}/)
"I'm getting a 400" / "It says REQUEST_VALIDATION_ERROR"	400 — Bad request / wrong data
"The CSV export isn't working" / "INVALID_DATETIMES"	400 — Bad request / wrong data

If the customer says...	Jump to section
"I'm getting 404" / "It says NO_CSV_AVAILABLE"	404 — Not found / missing data
"The event I'm looking for doesn't appear"	404 — Not found / missing data
"It says NO_RESULTS_FOUND"	404 — Not found / missing data
"It says REQUEST_TOO_LARGE" / "I sent many IDs"	414 — Request too large
"I'm getting 429 errors" / "I've been rate limited"	429 — Too many requests
"I keep hitting my rate limit" / "RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED"	429 — Too many requests
"I'm getting a 500" / "Internal server error"	500, 503, 504 — Smarkets server issues
"It says 503" / "Service unavailable"	500, 503, 504 — Smarkets server issues
"It says 504" / "Gateway timeout"	500, 503, 504 — Smarkets server issues
"It says ZEUS_TIMEOUT"	500, 503, 504 — Smarkets server issues
"My account is suspended"	403 — Permission problems
"How do I get API access?" / "The GBP150 fee"	Frequently asked questions
"Can I get 0% commission?"	Frequently asked questions
"Am I allowed to scrape data?"	Frequently asked questions
"What is Fill-or-Kill?" / "time_in_force" / "FOK"	Order types explained simply
"I'm paying 2% — can I get 1%?" / "Pro Tier"	Commission tiers
"My stake shows £0.08 instead of £2"	Price & quantity format
"I already tried waiting and it still doesn't work"	When to flag for technical support
"This doesn't match anything on this page"	When to flag for technical support

How API Calls Work

A customer's application sends a request to `https://api.smarkets.com`. Smarkets responds with a **three-digit status code** that tells you whether the request succeeded or what went wrong.

Code range	What it means	Whose problem is it?
2xx (200, 201, 204)	■ The request succeeded	No problem
4xx (400, 401, 403, 404, 414, 429, 451)	■ The customer's request had a problem	**Customer** — guide them to fix it
5xx (500, 503, 504)	■ Smarkets' systems had a problem	**Smarkets** — log and escalate

Your role is to identify which problem the customer has encountered and provide the appropriate guidance. If the issue falls outside the patterns below, flag it for technical support.

401 — Login / Token Issues ("Not logged in")

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 401 error" / "My token isn't working" / "It says AUTH_REQUIRED" / "I keep getting logged out" / "My session expired" / "I was working and suddenly it stopped"

What it means: The customer's session token is missing, expired, or invalid.

How it works (simple explanation): Using the Smarkets API requires a "session token" — like a ticket you get when you log in. Every request must present this ticket. The ticket is "valid for 30min, but if you make an authenticated request with it, it will be renewed for the next 30min." If the customer doesn't use the API for 30 minutes, the ticket expires and they need to log in again.

Things to check (in order):

1. **Has the token expired?** — Tokens last 30 minutes without activity. They need to log in again via `POST /v3/sessions/` to get a fresh token.

2. **Is the header formatted correctly?** — The token must be sent in the `Authorization` header exactly like this:

```
Authorization: Session-Token <their_token>
```

3. **Is two-factor authentication (MFA) enabled?** — After logging in, MFA requires an extra step: `POST /v3/sessions/verify/` with their TOTP code. Without this, the token is not fully authorised.

4. **Did they switch from paper trading to live trading (or vice versa)?** — Switching environments invalidates existing tokens. They need a fresh token from the new environment.

What to tell the customer:

> *Your session token has expired. Tokens are valid for 30 minutes without activity. To resolve this, log in again via `POST /v3/sessions/` with your email and password to receive a fresh token. Once obtained, include it in the `Authorization` header using the format `Authorization: Session-Token <your_token>` for all subsequent requests.*
>
> *Note that login is rate-limited to 5 attempts every 5 minutes — if you receive a 429 during login, you must wait before trying again.*

When to flag for technical support:

- 401 on POST requests but GET requests work fine (possible mixed authentication methods)
- The customer mentions "cookies", "auth v2", or "refresh tokens" (newer authentication schemes not covered here)
- The error response contains `data: None` (no further detail to identify the problem)
- The customer is getting 401 from the logout endpoint (`DELETE /v3/sessions/`) — this shouldn't happen normally

403 — Permission Problems ("Not allowed")

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 403 error" / "It says FORBIDDEN" / "I was working fine and now I'm blocked" / "My account can't do this" / "It says ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED" / "It says RG_ACK_REQUIRED" / "It says KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED" / "My account is suspended"

What it means: The customer's account lacks permission for the requested action.

Critical distinction
There are two types of 403. The response body tells you which one. If the response is **JSON**, it's an API permission issue. If the response is **HTML**, it's a Cloudflare network block. These have totally different fixes.

Type A: API-level 403 (response is JSON)

The response starts with `{"error_type": "FORBIDDEN", ...}`. This means the account itself is blocked from this action.

Reason	What's going on
Not approved for API access yet	They need to submit the API Request Form and pay the GBP150 fee
Under 60-day compliance review	"All customers will be subject to a compliance review of their account within the first 60 days." This is normal — wait for it to pass
Access suspended or revoked	They may have violated terms (scraping, sharing data, etc.)
Endpoint-specific 403s	See table below

Endpoint-specific 403 error codes (POST /v3/orders/):

Code	Meaning
`ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED`	Registration incomplete

Code	Meaning
NO_DEPOSITS	No money deposited
KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED	Identity not verified
ACTION_BLOCKED	Specific action blocked
RG_ACK_REQUIRED	Responsible gambling acknowledgement not completed

What to tell the customer:

> *This means your account does not have permission for that action. If you are within your first 60 days of API access, this is expected — your account is undergoing compliance review. If the issue persists beyond that period, contact api@smarkets.com to check your access status.*

Type B: Cloudflare network block (response is HTML)

Not an API issue — escalate to technical team
Response starts with `<!DOCTYPE` **or mentions "Cloudflare".** This is a network-level block at the edge, not an API authentication issue.

What to tell the customer:

> *This is a network-level block from Cloudflare, not an issue with your API credentials. It commonly affects requests from VPS, server, or data centre IP addresses. Smarkets does not offer IP whitelisting. Please contact our support team for assistance with this type of block.*

Login Errors (POST /v3/sessions/)

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I can't log in" / "It says INVALID_CREDENTIALS" / "My password isn't working" / "It says DEVICE_NOT_TRUSTED" / "It says SESSION_LIMIT_REACHED" / "It says COUNTRY_BLOCKED" / "I keep getting locked out"

What it means: Something is preventing the customer from completing the login process.

Quick tip: Login is rate-limited to **5 attempts per 300 seconds (5 minutes)**. If they try too many times, they'll get a 429 and must wait.

All login error codes — copy and Ctrl+F on this table:

Search for this code	HTTP	What it really means	What to tell them
INVALID_CREDENTIALS	401	Email/username or password is wrong	Reset password on smarkets.com
PASSWORD_RESET_NEEDED	401	The password must be reset before logging in	Reset password on smarkets.com
INVALID_DEVICE_COOKIE	400	Missing or broken device identifier	Ensure the request includes the device cookie
INVALID_TOKEN	400	Wrong TOTP code during MFA verification	Generate a new TOTP code and try again
DEVICE_NOT_TRUSTED	403	This device hasn't been marked as trusted	Complete device trust verification on smarkets.com
USER_SUSPENDED	403	Account has been suspended by Smarkets	Contact support@smarkets.com
USER_SELF_SUSPENDED	403	The customer put their own account on timeout	Wait for the timeout period to end
USER_ON_TIMEOUT	403	Too many failed login attempts — cooling off	Wait before trying again
USER_EXCLUDED	403	Account is self-excluded (responsible gambling)	Contact support for exclusion management

Search for this code	HTTP	What it really means	What to tell them
SESSION_LIMIT_REACHED	403	Too many active sessions already open	Log out from other sessions first
IP_NOT_TRUSTED	403	The IP address is not recognised	Complete device trust verification
SOURCE_BLOCKED	403	The traffic source is blocked	Contact support@smarkets.com
CLIENT_JURISDICTION_MISMATCH	403	Account country doesn't match the IP address	Contact support@smarkets.com
COUNTRY_BLOCKED	451	Smarkets not available in this country	No resolution available

400 — Bad Request / Wrong Data

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 400 error" / "It says REQUEST_VALIDATION_ERROR" / "The CSV export is failing" / "It says INVALID_DATETIMES" / "It says BAD_REQUEST" / "My order won't go through"

What it means: The data the customer sent is wrong — incorrect format, missing fields, or malformed parameters.

How it works: Validation errors always return a JSON body with `"error_type": "REQUEST_VALIDATION_ERROR"` and a `data` field explaining exactly what's wrong. **Read the `data` field — it tells you precisely what to fix.**

Common 400 error codes:

Search for this code	What it means	Fix
INVALID_DATETIMES	CSV start/end times are wrong	Start and end "have to be separated by an hour, also these have to be exactly on the hour" (e.g. 2:00 PM to 3:00 PM)
BAD_REQUEST	Parameters are badly formed (markets/prices endpoints)	Check the parameter format
REQUEST_VALIDATION_ERROR	Something is wrong with the request	Read the `data` field — it tells you what to fix
RECKONATOR_REQUEST_TOO_LARGE	Account activity query is too broad	Narrow the date range or reduce filters

What to tell the customer:

> *The API rejected your request because something in the data was incorrect. The `data` field in the error response will tell you precisely what is wrong.*
>
> *Common causes:*
>
> *- **Account activity CSV:** the start and end times must be exactly on the hour (e.g. 2:00 PM to 3:00 PM) and exactly one hour apart*
>
> *- **Placing an order:** required fields such as `price`, `quantity`, `contract_id`, or `side` may be missing*
>
> *- **IDs:** event, market, and contract IDs must be in the correct format (numeric strings)*
>
> *- **Too many IDs in one request:** split the request into smaller batches (the API returns 414 REQUEST_TOO_LARGE when you exceed the limit)*
>
> *- **Account activity request too large:** narrow your date range*
>
> *Check the error message carefully — it describes exactly what needs to be corrected.*

When to flag for technical support:

- The `data` field in the error response is empty or unclear
- You cannot determine which parameter is invalid from the error message

- The customer asks for specific valid values for `price` or `quantity` (these require exchange tick knowledge)
- Invalid price, invalid quantity, or other specialist order rejection codes (see Order Rejection section)

404 — Not Found / Missing Data

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 404" / "The CSV export is empty" / "The event I'm looking for doesn't appear" / "It says NO_CSV_AVAILABLE" / "It says NO_RESULTS_FOUND" / "I can't find this order" / "ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_FOUND"

What it means: The resource the customer is requesting does not exist.

Common 404 scenarios:

Search for this code	What happened	Fix
(generic 404)	Wrong ID — event, market, contract, or order doesn't exist	Verify the ID
`NO_CSV_AVAILABLE`	No activity data for the requested time range	Try a different date range
`NO_RESULTS_FOUND`	No events matched the query parameters	Adjust the search criteria
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_FOUND`	The order may have been filled and no longer exists	Verify the order ID via `GET /v3/orders/`

What to tell the customer:

> *The API cannot find what you are looking for. This usually means one of the following:*
>
> *- The event, market, contract, or order ID you are using is incorrect or doesn't exist*
>
> *- For the account activity CSV: no activity data exists for the time range you specified (you will receive a* `NO_CSV_AVAILABLE` *error)*
>
> *- For event states: no events match your criteria (you will receive a* `NO_RESULTS_FOUND` *error)*
>
> *- For cancelling an order: the order may have already been filled or doesn't exist*
>
> >
>
> *Verify your IDs by cross-referencing them against responses from the* `/v3/events/` *or* `/v3/accounts/` *endpoints.*

When to flag for technical support:

- The customer insists their IDs are correct but continues receiving 404 responses
- The endpoint itself appears to be incorrect (the customer may have the wrong URL)
- The customer needs guidance navigating Smarkets' event hierarchy to locate the correct IDs

414 — Request Too Large

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 414 error" / "It says REQUEST_TOO_LARGE" / "My events query stopped working" / "I sent many IDs at once"

What it means: The customer sent too many IDs in a single request. The API has limits on how many IDs it will accept at once.

Which endpoints this affects: Events, markets, contracts, and account activity endpoints that accept arrays of IDs.

What to tell the customer:

> *The API rejected your request because it contained too many IDs. You need to split your request into smaller batches. Try reducing the number of IDs you send at once and send multiple separate requests instead.*

When to flag for technical support:

- The customer is unsure what the ID limit is per request
- The customer needs to process a very large number of IDs efficiently

429 — Too Many Requests

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting 429 errors" / "I've been rate limited" / "It says RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED" / "I can't log in — too many attempts" / "I keep hitting my limit"

What it means: The customer has exceeded their pre-approved rate limit. They need to wait before making more requests.

The error response includes three useful fields: - `count` — how many requests they've already made - `limit` — their approved maximum - `expiry` — ISO timestamp of when the limit resets

Known per-endpoint rate limits:

Endpoint	Limit
Quotes (`GET /v3/markets/{ids}/quotes/`)	50 requests per 60 seconds
Login (`POST /v3/sessions/`)	5 requests per 300 seconds (5 minutes)
Cancel all orders (`DELETE /v3/orders/`)	1 request per 60 seconds
Cancel one order (`DELETE /v3/orders/{id}/`)	10 requests per second
Logout (`DELETE /v3/sessions/`)	30 requests per 60 seconds

Per Section 5 of the API terms: "exceeding them may lead to temporary suspension" and "repeated violations could result in API or account access being permanently revoked."

What to tell the customer:

> *You have exceeded your pre-approved rate limit. The error response includes an `expiry` timestamp showing when the limit resets — you must wait until that time before making further requests.*
>
> *To reduce how often you hit the limit:*
>
> *- Cache price data instead of polling the quotes endpoint repeatedly*
>
> *- Batch multiple IDs into a single request where the API supports it*
>
> *- Consider using the WebSocket feed for real-time data rather than HTTP polling*
>
> *- Note that login is limited to 5 attempts every 5 minutes*
>
> *If your use case genuinely requires higher limits, contact api@smarkets.com to discuss.*

When to flag for technical support:

- The customer is hitting limits despite very low apparent usage (possible multiple clients sharing the same account)
- The customer's account has been suspended due to repeated rate limit violations
- The customer needs assistance setting up WebSocket feeds
- The customer mentions Cloudflare-based rate limiting rather than API rate limiting

451 — Country Blocked

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting a 451 error" / "It says COUNTRY_BLOCKED" / "I can't access the API from my location" / "I'm travelling and it stopped working"

What it means: Smarkets does not offer services in the customer's country or the country their IP address is coming from.

What to tell the customer:

> *Your location or account jurisdiction is not supported by Smarkets. This is a geographic restriction and is not related to your credentials or API setup. If you believe this is an error, contact support@smarkets.com to discuss.*

When to flag for technical support:

- The customer is located in a normally supported country but is receiving this error (possible mismatched account jurisdiction)
- The customer wishes to discuss jurisdiction restrictions

500, 503 & 504 — Smarkets Server Issues

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I'm getting 500 errors" / "Internal server error" / "Service unavailable" / "Gateway timeout" / "It says ZEUS_TIMEOUT" / "It says KYC_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE" / "It says EVENTS_UNAVAILABLE"

What it means: Something went wrong on Smarkets' side. This is **not caused by the customer**. Nothing they do differently will fix it.

Cause is on Smarkets side — do not blame the customer
500 = Smarkets system crashed. 503 = Specific subsystem is down. 504 = Backend timed out. All are server-side issues. Tell the customer to wait and retry, then escalate to api@smarkets.com if it persists.

The three types:

HTTP	Name	Meaning
500	Internal Server Error	A Smarkets system crashed. Retry in a few minutes.
503	Service Unavailable	A specific Smarkets system is down. The error code tells you which one (see table below).
504	Gateway Timeout	A Smarkets backend system didn't respond in time.

503 error codes — which system is affected:

Search for this code	System affected
`KYC_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE`, `KYC_SERVICE_INTERNAL_ERROR`	KYC verification system (order placement)
`AUTH_UNAVAILABLE`	Authentication system (login, orders)
`ORDER_UNAVAILABLE`	Order processing system
`CREATE_ORDER_TIMEOUT`, `CANCEL_ORDER_TIMEOUT`, `CANCEL_ALL_TIMEOUT`	Order processing — timed out
`CANCEL_ALL_UNAVAILABLE`	Cancel-all orders system
`EVENTS_UNAVAILABLE`, `EVENTS_INTERNAL_ERROR`, `EVENTS_API_RATE_LIMIT`	Events/markets data system
`CHARTS_INTERNAL_ERROR`, `CHARTS_UNAVAILABLE`	Price charts system
`MDS_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE`	Market data service (prices, volumes)
`FOREX_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE`, `FOREX_SERVICE_INTERNAL_ERROR`	Currency conversion system
`RECKONATOR_UNAVAILABLE`	Account activity/reconciliation system
`PROMOTION_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE`	Promotions system (order retrieval)
`ZEUS_UNAVAILABLE`, `ZEUS_CONNECTION_ERROR`	Core trading engine (order retrieval)

What to tell the customer:

> *This is a server-side issue, not a problem with your request. A 500 means a temporary system failure. 503 and 504 errors mean a specific Smarkets system is temporarily unavailable or timing out.*

>

Please wait a few minutes and try again. If the issue persists, report it to api@smarkets.com with the full error details, including the specific error code — this helps the engineering team identify the affected system.

When to flag for technical support:

- Always flag 500, 503, and 504 errors — they are server-side and should be reported to api@smarkets.com
- Note the specific error code — it helps identify which system is affected
- If the customer says "I tried waiting and it still happens" — this confirms a real outage, escalate

Order Rejection Codes (POST /v3/orders/)

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"My order was rejected" / "I can't place a bet" / "It says ORDER_REJECTED_INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS" / "It says ORDER_INVALID_INVALID_PRICE" / "It says KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED"

What it means: The API refused to place an order. Each rejection has a specific code that tells you exactly why.

The code itself tells you what's wrong — no interpretation needed. Ask the customer for the exact error code from the response.

Group 1: Money and limits

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS`	Not enough money in the account	Check available balance via `GET /v3/accounts/`. Open orders also consume balance through exposure
`ORDER_REJECTED_STAKE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED`	Bet is too large for the account's limit	Reduce the stake or contact support to adjust limits
`ORDER_REJECTED_LIMIT_EXCEEDED`	Too many open orders already	Cancel some existing orders before placing new ones
`NO_DEPOSITS`	No money has ever been deposited	Make a deposit first

Group 2: Market state

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_MARKET_SETTLED`	The market has already finished	Bets can no longer be placed — the event has concluded
`ORDER_REJECTED_CONTRACT_SETTLED`	That specific betting option has settled	Choose a different contract within the same market
`ORDER_REJECTED_MARKET_NOT_OPEN`	The market isn't accepting bets yet	Wait until the market opens
`ORDER_REJECTED_MARKET_HALTED`	Trading was paused (e.g. during in-play delay)	Wait for the market to resume
`ORDER_REJECTED_TRADING_SUSPENDED`	Trading is temporarily suspended	Wait for trading to resume
`ORDER_CANCELLED_MARKET_HALTED`	Order was cancelled because the market was halted	Wait and re-submit
`ORDER_CANCELLED_TRADING_SUSPENDED`	Order was cancelled because trading was suspended	Wait and re-submit

Group 3: Wrong values

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_INVALID_INVALID_PRICE`	The price is not a valid tick on the exchange	Price must be in percentage basis points. Example: 5000 = 50%. To convert to decimal odds, divide 10000 by it. Example: 10000 / 5000 = 2.0
`ORDER_INVALID_INVALID_QUANTITY`	The stake amount is not valid	Minimum is 500 (= 0.05 GBP). The units are 1/10000 of one unit of the user's currency

Group 4: Conflicts and throttling

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_CROSSED_SELF`	They're trying to match their own opposing order	Adjust the price so it doesn't conflict with their own existing orders
`ORDER_REJECTED_THROTTLE_EXCEEDED`	Placing orders too fast	Slow down — wait a bit before the next order

Group 5: Not found

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_MARKET_NOT_FOUND`	That market ID doesn't exist	Verify the market ID
`ORDER_REJECTED_CONTRACT_NOT_FOUND`	That contract ID doesn't exist	Verify the contract ID

Group 6: Account issues

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_ACCOUNT_SUSPENDED`	Account is suspended	Contact support@smarkets.com
`KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED`	Identity verification not completed	Verify their identity on smarkets.com
`ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED`	Account registration incomplete	Complete registration and verification
`RG_ACK_REQUIRED`	Responsible gambling acknowledgement needed	Complete the RG acknowledgement on smarkets.com
`ACTION_BLOCKED`	A specific action was blocked	Contact support@smarkets.com
`COUNTRY_BLOCKED` (returns as 451)	Country region is restricted	Smarkets not available in this region

Group 7: Market capacity

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_CAPACITY_REACHED`	Maximum orders reached for this market	Try a different market or wait
`ORDER_CANCELLED_INSUFFICIENT_LIQUIDITY`	Not enough other people betting to fill the order	Reduce the quantity or adjust the price

Group 8: System issues

Search for this code	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_REJECTED_SERVICE_TEMPORARILY_UNAVAILABLE`	Smarkets system is temporarily down	Wait and retry — server-side issue
`ORDER_CANCELLED_MEMBER_REQUESTED`	Order was cancelled by the customer themselves	This is informational — the cancellation was intentional
`ORDER_CANCELLED_ADMIN_REQUESTED`	Order was cancelled by Smarkets admin	If unexpected, contact api@smarkets.com

Cancel-Order Rejection Codes (DELETE /v3/orders/{order_id}/)

Common customer complaints — Ctrl+F these phrases
"I can't cancel my order" / "It says ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED" / "The delete order endpoint isn't working" / "It says ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_FOUND" / "It says ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_TOO_LATE"

What it means: The API refused to cancel an order. These are **different** from the order-placing rejection codes above.

Note: Cancel-all (`DELETE /v3/orders/`) has a rate limit of **1 request per 60 seconds**. Single cancellation (`DELETE /v3/orders/{id}/`) has a limit of **10 requests per second**.

Search for this code	HTTP	What it means	What to tell them
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_FOUND`	404	The order ID doesn't exist	Verify the order ID via `GET /v3/orders/`
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_LIVE`	400	The order is already filled or cancelled	No action needed — it's already resolved
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_TOO_LATE`	400	The market has already settled	Orders can't be reversed after settlement
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS`	400	Not enough funds to process the cancellation	Rare — contact api@smarkets.com
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_TRADING_SUSPENDED`	400	Trading is suspended	Wait for trading to resume
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_ACCOUNT_SUSPENDED`	400	Account is suspended	Contact support@smarkets.com
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_MARKET_NOT_FOUND`	400	The market for this order doesn't exist	Verify the order and market IDs
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_THROTTLE_EXCEEDED`	400	Too many cancellation attempts	Wait — limit is 10 cancellations per second
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_STAKE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED`	400	Account stake limit issue	Contact support
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_CAPACITY_REACHED`	400	Market at max cancellation capacity	Try again shortly
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_LIMIT_EXCEEDED`	400	Hit the cancellation limit for this period	Wait for the limit to reset
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_INVALID_QUANTITY`	400	Invalid partial cancellation amount	Verify the quantity parameter
`ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_SERVICE_TEMPORARILY_UNAVAILABLE`	400	Smarkets system temporarily down	Wait and retry — server-side issue

Common Customer Scenarios

How to use this section
These are real-world customer issues that don't fit neatly into one error code. They come from actual support tickets.

"I placed a bet via the API but I don't see it on the website"

Check: Did the POST /v3/orders/ response include an `id` field?

- If yes, the order was accepted. Check if the order state is "open" or "filled" via `GET /v3/orders/`.
- If the order is "filled", it should appear in the customer's bet history on the website.
- If the order is "open" (unmatched), it may not be visible in the same way as website-placed bets — check the "Your Bets" section.

"I have money in my account but the API says INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS"

Most common cause: Exposure from existing open orders is consuming the available balance.

What to check:

1. Are there open (unmatched) orders consuming balance? Check via `GET /v3/orders/`.
2. If the customer has lay bets open, the liability of those bets is locked up as exposure.
3. Cancel unwanted open orders to free up balance.

"My quotes endpoint returns empty but the website shows prices"

This is a known behaviour, not a bug. The API quotes endpoint returns only the **peer-to-peer order book** — bets placed by other exchange customers. The website may also show prices from Smarkets' own market-making system, which is not exposed via the API.

What to tell the customer: The quotes endpoint returns only peer-to-peer order book data. First-party market-making prices visible on the website are not available via the API. This is by design, not a bug.

"I can place bets on the website but not via the API (403 RG_ACK_REQUIRED)"

This is one of the most common onboarding errors. The customer has API access approved, but they haven't completed the Responsible Gambling acknowledgement popup on the website.

Fix: Log in to smarkets.com, complete the RG acknowledgement popup, then try the API again. The block lifts immediately — no code changes needed.

Don't tell them to re-apply for API access or pay the fee again — they've already done that if they received this specific error code.

"I'm getting a different commission rate than expected"

Check what `commission_type` value they're seeing:

- `0.02` = Standard Tier (2%) — the default. Correct for new API accounts.
- `0.01` = Pro Tier (1%) — requires opt-in after meeting volume thresholds.
- `0.03` = Select Tier (3%) — applied automatically based on profitability.

API access does NOT give a lower commission rate. See Commission Tiers for the full explanation.

"I used immediate_or_cancel with minimum_accepted_quantity but got a partial fill"

This has been reported by customers. The behaviour depends on the exact values used. If `minimum_accepted_quantity` was set to the full `quantity`, a partial fill should not occur — the order should either fill completely or be cancelled.

What to ask the customer:

1. What exact values did you send for `quantity` and `minimum_accepted_quantity`?
2. What was the full API response (including `total_executed_quantity`)?
3. Were you testing on paper or live?

If the values look correct and a partial fill still occurred, escalate to api@smarkets.com with the full request/response details.

"I sent quantity 800 but it only bet £0.08"

This is a unit conversion issue. The API uses 1/10,000th of the customer's currency unit. So `quantity: 800` = £0.08, not £2.00. For £2.00, the customer needs to send `quantity: 20000`.

See Price & Quantity Format for the full conversion table.

"My POST /v3/orders/ response doesn't include fill information"

The POST response for `immediate_or_cancel` orders returns `total_executed_quantity` — the amount matched at placement time. It does NOT return `quantity_filled` or `state`. Those fields exist on the GET endpoint (`GET /v3/orders/{id}/`), not the POST response.

For `good_til_cancelled` orders, the POST response simply confirms the order was accepted — it won't match until another customer takes the other side.

"I can't access the API from my VPS/server"

This is likely a Cloudflare edge block, not an API authentication issue. Check if the 403 response is HTML (starts with `<!DOCTYPE`) rather than JSON. If it's HTML, it's a network-level block that Smarkets cannot fix via API settings.

Smarkets does not offer IP whitelisting. The customer should contact support to discuss their specific situation.

Quick Reference Table

HTTP	Plain English	What to do	Search for this error code
400	Customer sent wrong data	Read the `data` field in the error — it says what's wrong	REQUEST_VALIDATION_ERROR, INVALID_DATETIMES, BAD_REQUEST, RECKONATOR_REQUEST_TOO_LARGE
401	Not logged in / token expired	Get a fresh token via `POST /v3/sessions/`	AUTH_REQUIRED
403 (JSON)	No permission — account-level	Check API approval, compliance review, or suspension	FORBIDDEN, KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED, ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED, NO_DEPOSITS, RG_ACK_REQUIRED, ACTION_BLOCKED
403 (HTML)	Cloudflare network block	**Not an API issue** — flag for technical support	Response starts with `<!DOCTYPE`
404	Data doesn't exist	Verify IDs or check time ranges	NO_CSV_AVAILABLE, NO_RESULTS_FOUND, ORDER_CANCEL_REJECTED_NOT_FOUND
414	Too many IDs in one request	Split into smaller batches	REQUEST_TOO_LARGE
429	Hit rate limit — too fast	Wait until the `expiry` time in the error	RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED
451	Country not supported	Geographic restriction — not a credentials issue	COUNTRY_BLOCKED
500	Smarkets crashed internally	Customer should wait and retry	INTERNAL_ERROR
503	Specific Smarkets system is down	Wait and retry; note the error code for engineering	KYC_SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE, EVENTS_UNAVAILABLE, ZEUS_UNAVAILABLE, etc.
504	Smarkets backend timed out	Wait and retry; flag if persistent	ZEUS_TIMEOUT, RECKONATOR_UNAVAILABLE

Frequently Asked Questions

Getting Started

"How do I get API access?"

Submit the API Request Form. After approval, a **GBP150 administration fee** is deducted from their account balance. Per Section 3: "Should you choose to permanently withdraw from API usage within the first 60 days, your setup fee will be refunded." All new API accounts undergo a **compliance review** during this 60-day period (Section 2).

"How long does API approval take?"

This is not documented with a specific timeframe. Tell the customer: "Applications are reviewed on a case-by-case basis. You'll be contacted once your application has been processed. If you haven't heard back

after a reasonable period, contact api@smarkets.com."

"Can I get a refund on the £150 fee?"

Yes — but only if you permanently withdraw from API usage within the first 60 days. Per Section 3 of the API T&Cs: "Should you choose to permanently withdraw from API usage within the first 60 days, your setup fee will be refunded."

"Can I get read-only API access?"

No. Smarkets does not offer a read-only or data-only API tier. The API is a single product — full access only, GBP150 setup fee. Standalone data extraction is not a permitted use per Section 2 of the T&Cs.

"Which markets can I access via the API?"

API access is restricted to pre-approved events and markets, determined per-account during the application process. The pre-approved list is not published. If a customer cannot access a specific market, it may be outside their approved scope. They should contact api@smarkets.com with the event/market details to check.

Commission

"Can I get the 0% commission?"

No. Per Section 3: "API customers are ineligible for any affiliate commission offers, as well as the 60 day 0% commission offer for new customers." Standard Customer Commission (2%) applies.

"Can I get a lower commission rate as an API user?"

API access does not give you a lower commission rate. The same three-tier system applies to everyone:

- **Standard (2%)** — default
- **Pro (1%)** — opt in after 1,500 bets/month or £1M staked/month (80% threshold required)
- **Select (3%)** — auto-applied when net profit exceeds £25,000 over 12 months

See the Commission Tiers section for full details.

"I'm on the Select Tier — can I go back to Standard?"

If your net P&L over the previous 12 calendar months falls below £25,000, you can apply to have your commission rate reviewed. Contact customer service to request a review.

Data & Usage

"Am I allowed to scrape odds or market data?"

No. Per Section 2: "All other uses are strictly prohibited, including but not limited to, odds scraping, concealing API calls, browser impersonation or reverse engineering." Violations may result in API removal, bet cancellation, account suspension or closure, and legal action.

"Can I share market data with a friend or third party?"

No. Per Section 5: "You may not share, sell or distribute platform data — such as prices, market status, events or business information — with third parties without written approval from Smarkets."

"Can I use the API to benchmark Smarkets against other exchanges?"

No. The API must not be used to benchmark Smarkets' markets, prices, liquidity, systems, or services for competitive purposes. This is a policy issue — if the customer's intended use involves comparison or benchmarking, they should contact api@smarkets.com before continuing.

"Can I use the API mainly to collect data without trading?"

No. Per the T&Cs, API access is intended for trading-related use. Using it mainly to extract data without commensurate trading activity may lead to restrictions or removal of access.

Orders

"How do I cancel an order?"

Use `DELETE /v3/orders/{order_id}/` to cancel a specific order, or `DELETE /v3/orders/` to cancel **all** open orders.

Action	Rate limit
Cancel one order	10 requests per second
Cancel all orders	1 request per 60 seconds

"How do I place a Fill-or-Kill order?"

Set `type` to `"immediate_or_cancel"` AND set `minimum_accepted_quantity` to the same value as `quantity`. See Order Types for details.

"What does a 504 error mean?"

A 504 Gateway Timeout means a Smarkets backend system didn't respond in time. Common codes: `ZEUS_TIMEOUT` (core trading engine timeout on order retrieval) and `RECKONATOR_UNAVAILABLE` (activity/reconciliation timeout). Retry after a short wait; escalate to api@smarkets.com if persistent.

Sessions

"How long does a session token last?"

Tokens are "valid for 30min, but if you make an authenticated request with it, it will be renewed for the next 30min." So as long as they use the API regularly, the token stays alive. Login is limited to **5 attempts every 5 minutes**.

"Which API endpoints don't need a token?"

Events, competitors, contracts, and currencies can be accessed without authentication. Market data endpoints (quotes, prices) require authentication. Prices without a token will be delayed. Session endpoints (login, logout, MFA) also don't need prior authentication.

Support

"Who do I escalate to?"

Issue	Contact
Technical API support	api@smarkets.com
General support / account issues	support@smarkets.com
Swagger documentation	docs.smarkets.com
Help centre	help.smarkets.com/hc/en-gb

API Terms & Policy Quick Reference

Use this section when a customer asks why API access has been refused, limited, suspended, or revoked
Keep replies factual and avoid making promises about approval, reinstatement, or market coverage. Do not give the customer detailed internal reasoning for a suspension or compliance decision unless it has already been approved for customer communication. If the case is sensitive or disputed, escalate it.

Ongoing requirements after approval:

API approval is not a one-off entitlement. Customers may be asked to provide details of their technical setup and how they intend to use the API. They must also keep Smarkets updated if their setup or intended use changes.

What to tell the customer: API access is subject to ongoing review. We may ask for information about how you use the API, including your technical setup and intended interaction with Smarkets. If that information is not provided, access may not be approved or may be removed.

Pre-approved events and markets only:

API usage is restricted to pre-approved events and markets. If a customer cannot access a market or event through the API, it may be outside their approved scope.

Benchmarking and competitive monitoring:

Customers must not use the API or Smarkets data to benchmark markets, prices, liquidity, systems, or services for competitive purposes.

Data extraction without trading:

Customers must not use the API mainly to extract data without a reasonable level of trading activity. This can still be a breach even if the customer has valid API access.

Additional fees and restrictions:

The £150 setup fee is not the only possible API-related cost. Some usage may be subject to specific restrictions and/or additional fees.

Grounds for suspension or termination:

Reason	What it means	Agent guidance
Data harvesting	High volumes of pricing/market data requested without corresponding trading activity	Do not debate the data pattern. Explain that API access is not for data harvesting and escalate if the customer disputes.
Fee avoidance	Creating multiple accounts to avoid commission thresholds	Escalate. Do not give advice on how to structure accounts or avoid fees.
Unfair trading	Strategies Smarkets views as harmful (latency arbitrage, court-siding)	Keep the reply brief and policy-based. Escalate if the customer challenges.

Account Verification (KYC)

When customers ask about verification
"I can't place bets" / "It says KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED" / "It says ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED" / "Why do I need to verify my account?"

What is KYC?

KYC (Know Your Customer) is a legal requirement for all gambling operators. Smarkets must verify a customer's identity, age, and address before they can place bets. This applies to website, mobile, and API users equally.

Common KYC-related error codes

Code	What it means	What to tell the customer
`KYC_PERMISSION_DENIED`	Identity verification not completed	Complete identity verification on smarkets.com
`ACCOUNT_UNVERIFIED`	Account registration incomplete	Complete registration and verification on smarkets.com

What the customer needs to do

If a customer is getting KYC errors:

1. Log in to smarkets.com (the website, not the API)
2. Complete any outstanding verification steps — this may include uploading ID documents, proof of address, or source of funds information
3. Once verification is complete, the API access will work automatically — no code changes needed

Source of Funds & Wealth

Some customers may be asked to provide source of funds or source of wealth documentation. This is a standard AML (Anti-Money Laundering) requirement and is not specific to API users. If a customer asks why they need to provide this, explain that it's a regulatory requirement for all gambling operators, not a Smarkets-specific policy.

Deposits & Withdrawals

When customers ask about payments
"How do I deposit?" / "Why was my withdrawal delayed?" / "The payment name doesn't match my account"

Payment methods

Smarkets supports various payment methods including debit cards, bank transfers, and e-wallets. The exact methods available depend on the customer's jurisdiction. Available methods are listed on the smarkets.com deposit page.

Payment name mismatch

A common issue: the customer's deposit was made from an account with a slightly different name (e.g., a joint account, married name, or abbreviation). Smarkets requires the payment name to match the account name for AML compliance.

What to tell the customer:

> *The name on your payment method must match the name on your Smarkets account. If there's a difference (due to marriage, deed poll, joint account, or abbreviation), please contact support@smarkets.com with documentation showing both names refer to you.*

Closed-loop payments

Smarkets operates a closed-loop payment policy — withdrawals must be made to the same method used for deposit. If a customer asks to withdraw to a different method, explain this is an AML requirement.

Withdrawal timelines

Withdrawal processing times vary by method:

- Debit card: typically 1-3 business days
- Bank transfer: typically 1-5 business days

These are estimates, not guarantees. If a withdrawal is significantly delayed, the customer should contact support@smarkets.com.

Responsible Gambling

When customers ask about responsible gambling
"How do I set limits?" / "I want to self-exclude" / "What is RG_ACK_REQUIRED?" / "I put my account on timeout"

RG_ACK_REQUIRED

This is one of the most common onboarding errors. The customer has API access approved but gets a 403 `RG_ACK_REQUIRED` when trying to place orders.

What it means: The account IS approved for API use. But the Responsible Gambling acknowledgement popup on the website has not been completed. This is a one-time regulatory step required before any account can place bets.

Fix: Log in to smarkets.com, complete the RG acknowledgement popup, then try the API again. If the customer can't find the popup, suggest navigating to a market page which may trigger it.

Self-exclusion and timeouts

Code	What it means	What to tell the customer
`USER_SELF_SUSPENDED`	The customer put their own account on timeout	Wait for the timeout period to end
`USER_EXCLUDED`	Account is self-excluded	Contact support for exclusion management
`USER_ON_TIMEOUT`	Too many failed login attempts	Wait before trying again

If a customer wants to self-exclude or set deposit limits, direct them to the Safer Gambling section of smarkets.com or to help.smarkets.com — Safer Gambling.

When to Flag for Technical Support

If you've read through this guide and can't find the answer, or if the customer's situation matches one of these, **pass it to technical support**:

Situation	Why it's outside this guide
Cloudflare/edge blocks — response is HTML	Not an API issue — requires network investigation
Account suspensions and compliance disputes	Requires human judgement and sensitive handling
"curl works but my code doesn't"	Development/debugging issue — not API support
WebSocket feed setup	Separate system with different documentation
Auth v2, refresh tokens, or cookies	Newer authentication scheme not covered here
Persistent 500, 503, or 504 errors	Server-side — report to api@smarkets.com
Customer shares raw request/response data you can't interpret	Better to escalate than guess
Anything that doesn't match a known pattern	It's safer to escalate than provide wrong advice
Oddsfeed, OAuth2, or third-party integrations	May follow different documentation and authentication flows
Quotes endpoint returns empty book while website shows prices	Known behaviour, but if the customer disputes the explanation, escalate

Useful Links & Resources

For customers:

- API Base URL: `https://api.smarkets.com`
- Swagger Documentation: docs.smarkets.com
- API Request Form: support.smarkets.com/p/6MLL-PL7/api-request-form
- Help Centre: help.smarkets.com/hc/en-gb
- Commission FAQ: help.smarkets.com — Commission FAQ
- Betting Education: help.smarkets.com — Education
- Betting Rules: help.smarkets.com — Betting Rules

For internal escalation:

- Technical API support: api@smarkets.com
- General support / account issues: support@smarkets.com

Help Centre categories:

- Betting: Education, Calculators, Betting on Smarkets, Bonus & Promotions
- Account & Payment: Your Account, Account Verification, Payments, Source of Funds & Wealth
- Using Smarkets: Safer Gambling, Betting Rules, Terms & Conditions, Contact Us

Last updated: June 2026 | Owner: API Support Team | Source: help.smarkets.com, docs.smarkets.com, live OpenAPI v3 spec | Audit: Full cross-reference against live spec conducted May 2026, expanded June 2026 with exchange concepts, order types, commission tiers, and customer scenarios